ORIGINAL WORK SAMPLE

# Writing for security operations teams

Opening page from my client guide, retaining the original writing and layout.

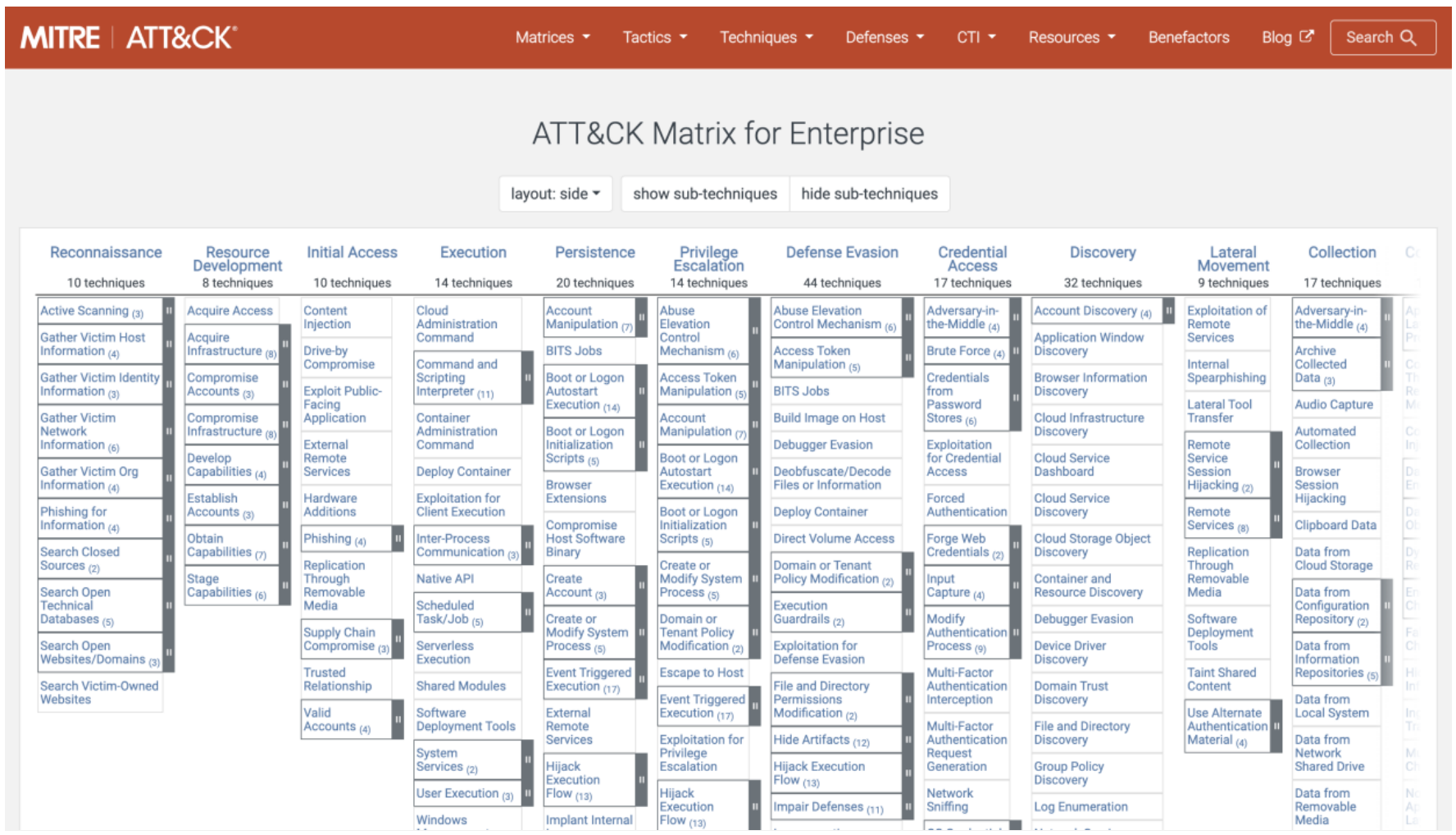
**A Guide to MITRE ATT&CK for SOC Teams & Corresponding MITRE ATT&CK Cheat Sheet**

🚀 As a Security Operations Team, your goal is to protect the system from incoming threats. Not only that, but you must be the first to know when a breach takes place. This means you are responsible for protection and detection, as well as incident response and recovery. You must also identify potential threats in your system to take pre-emptive measures by blocking as many attack pathways as possible while seamlessly integrating these measures in a way that does not disrupt organizational or business operations.

To do this, you must have a clear-cut understanding of adversaries' potential threats by analyzing their most commonly used tools and techniques. This is where MITRE ATT&CK comes into play…

**What is MITRE ATT&CK?**

💥 **MITRE ATT&CK can be viewed as a comprehensive, structured knowledge base of adversary tactics and techniques based on real-world observations.** It aids SOC teams in understanding how adversaries operate, identifying gaps in security posture, and improving threat detection and response strategies within their domain.




MITRE ATT&CK homepage

When SOC teams create security rules, such as firewall or SIEM rules, they must ensure that their rules cover all aspects of the attack vector space that an adversary could potentially exploit.

FREELANCE TECHNICAL WRITING | MARCH 2025

# Making security frameworks usable for practitioners

An Upwork client engagement: a SOC-focused MITRE ATT&CK guide and reference sheet.

### Audience and purpose

Help security operations teams understand tactics, techniques, procedures, and how a common vocabulary supports investigation and communication.

### My contribution

Researched and wrote the guide, connected the framework with SOC and NIST-related discussion, and created an Enterprise ATT&CK quick-reference sheet.

## A reader-first structure

**Orient**
Explain the framework

→

**Connect**
Relate it to workflows

→

**Illustrate**
Use practical examples

→

**Reference**
Provide a quick guide

MITRE ATT&CK guide for SOC teams | Client writing engagement, March 2025.

ORIGINAL WORK SAMPLE

# A practical quick-reference sheet

A page from the companion reference table: tactics, explanations, and examples.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Initial Access** | Techniques used to gain a foothold within a target network. | Phishing, Exploit Public-Facing Application, Drive-by Compromise |
| **Execution** | Executing malicious code to achieve attacker objectives. | Command and Scripting Interpreter, Exploitation for Client Execution, Scheduled Task/Job |
| **Persistence** | Maintaining access to the target system after gaining initial access. | Boot or Logon Autostart Execution, Hijack Execution Flow, Account Manipulation |
| **Privilege Escalation** | Gaining higher-level permissions to further compromise the system. | Abuse Elevation Control Mechanism, Exploitation for Privilege Escalation, Access Token Manipulation |
| **Defense Evasion** | Avoiding detection by security tools and analysts. | Obfuscation/Deobfuscation, Disable Security Tools, Indicator Removal |
| **Credential Access** | Stealing or brute-forcing credentials to expand access. | Brute Force, Credential Dumping, Input Capture |
| **Discovery** | Identifying system information, security tools, and account privileges. | Network Service Scanning, File and Directory Discovery, Software Discovery |
| **Lateral Movement** | Moving within the network to reach valuable assets. | Remote Services, Internal Spearphishing, Lateral Tool Transfer |
| **Collection** | Gathering data of interest before exfiltration. | Screen Capture, Keylogging, Audio Capture |
| **Command and Control** | Establishing communication between the attacker and compromised systems. | C2 over Web Protocols, Encrypted Channel, Remote Access Software |
| **Exfiltration** | Removing sensitive data from the compromised system. | Automated Exfiltration, Exfiltration Over Web, Scheduled Transfer |
| **Impact** | Manipulating, disrupting, or destroying systems, data, or services. | Data Encryption for Impact, Disk Wipe, Defacement |

MITRE ATT&CK Cheat Sheet for Enterprise Tactics

**Conclusion: Message to SOC Teams**

**Use MITRE ATT&CK.** The tools are available to help you enhance your security posture. This framework is continually updated by MITRE to provide the latest intelligence on adversary tactics, techniques, and real-world attack procedures. Leverage this knowledge base to proactively defend against evolving cyber threats.